

financial issues. When it comes to stress, we often think about the stress of work or family commitments, yet money is the number one cause of stress for us and the number one cause of divorce. With those statistics, you'd think we would have a bit more access to financial literacy tools. Or at least a pamphlet.

Financial stability has a powerful flow-on effect in our lives. In fact, in 2022 the study 'The impact of a poverty reduction intervention on infant brain activity' found that providing mothers of newborns an extra \$300 a month for a year ended up improving babies' brain development compared to those whose mothers were only given \$20 a month. This points to the socioeconomic effects money has on our lives. Up to a certain level, money improves our wellbeing and physical and mental health outcomes; it improves our ability to access higher education, network into better paying jobs and frees up our time to connect with our communities.

A bird does not fear the branch beneath it breaking because it has faith in its wings. When you are financially independent and financially literate, you are more empowered and in a better position to make the calls in your life. No matter what life can throw at you, whether it's curveballs in your career or with the people around you, if you are financially secure, you will always have one less thing to worry about.

Nothing compares to the feeling of being completely self-reliant.

More importantly, investing helps to grow your wealth, giving women the freedom to leave any situation that does not serve them. Being financially independent means no strings attached. It means not having to listen to someone micromanage where you spend your money. Or putting up with a boss who makes you uncomfortable. It means not needing to stick it out in a career that drains you. No matter what the situation is, many women find extreme joy in investing for financial freedom.

Create a better world

Many people think money and creating social change are mutually exclusive, and that money is the root of all evil. This couldn't be further